

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1056

By Parkinson

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor U.S. Marine Corps
veteran Joe Northington.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal safety and concerns to ensure our individual and collective freedom, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant men and women who have performed above and beyond the call of duty; and

WHEREAS, the citizens of Tennessee have, throughout the years, been called upon to take up arms against the enemies of this great nation, risking their lives and leaving their loved ones behind to honorably safeguard the freedoms and liberties guaranteed to all citizens of these United States and vanquishing those who threaten our way of life; and

WHEREAS, while the heroic deeds of Tennesseans have been extolled throughout the history of our State and nation, the distinguished military service of every proud Tennessean should be illuminated, shared, and properly honored; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Joe Northington, a gallant veteran of the United States Marine Corps, whose courage and composure in perilous circumstances helped save the life of a fellow servicemember; and

WHEREAS, in the darkness of war, a deadly explosion tore through a Marine platoon, leaving men critically wounded, including the lieutenant, who was bleeding severely from multiple shrapnel wounds; and

WHEREAS, without hesitation, Joe Northington stepped forward and treated the wounded; he applied a tourniquet that helped stop the lieutenant's bleeding and stabilize him; and

WHEREAS, with no proper signal for rescue, Mr. Northington improvised, using only a penlight placed in a ration can to guide a medivac helicopter safely to their position; and

WHEREAS, then, alongside fellow Marines, he carried the lieutenant to the helicopter, thus ensuring he made it out alive; and

WHEREAS, today, Joe Northington is a Purple Heart recipient and devoted husband, father, grandfather, and great-grandfather; he is faithful to his church and his community and highly regarded by all those who are fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, while no offering can properly relay our gratitude for his bravery and dedication, it is most appropriate that we should honor Mr. Northington to the full extent of our ability; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor U.S. Marine Corps veteran Joe Northington, extending our gratitude for his bravery during battle and our best wishes for his every continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.